

Billion BiGuard S20

Fitting Gatekeeper For Your Office Network



The Billion BiGuard S20 is a network switch with a lot of focus on security and virtual networking. The hardware has 8 ports for the LAN and 2 ports for WAN. There is even a Gigabit Ethernet port for high speed backbone links to other switches or networks.

A Web interface is used to control and monitor the various features. The interface is plain and easy to use. The WAN ports can be set up to dial using PPPoE to ISPs and there are features for load balancing between the connections in the device. Features for bandwidth monitoring and throttling are also present. All the features have logs that can be viewed and e-mail alerts can be sent automatically. Other than the standard features, there is a lot of emphasis on security, SSL and virtual private networks.

The router generates almost no heat, and the Web interface doesn't slow down under load. Overall, the BiGuard S20

is very good as a switch. It has features perfect for offices, but at Rs 30,000, it is an expensive piece of equipment to consider. It might be worth it if you really need the plethora of security and features it offers.

Specifications

Four 10/100 Mbps ports, Two WAN ports, One Gigabit port, RS232 Console connector

Contact: One Network (India) Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: +91-9821014253
E-mail: deepak@onenetwork.co.in
Web site: www.billion.com
Price: Rs 30,000

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Microsoft Sidewinder Mouse

Stretching Ergonomics To The Extreme

Microsoft's Siderwinder mouse has seen a lot of hype over of its design. Another mouse to create such a racket about its shape was the Logitech G9, which we tested a while back.

The size of the Sidewinder mouse is monstrous. It is one of the largest mice we've come across. Users with huge hands will find this comfortable, but those with smaller palms will find it hard to hold on to. The sides of your



finger won't come close to touching the surface. The scroll doesn't have a prominent gritty ride to it. The wheel is heavy duty. The buttons are quite soft and feel somewhere between Logitech and the Razer mice.

The mouse performs flawlessly. There is no skipping but playing with a mouse that large can take a while to get used to. There are three buttons to change the resolution of the sensor and a small display which shows the current DPI setting. The three levels can be set using the driver.

The mouse itself is pretty heavy but it also feels very hollow. Additional weights for the mouse are supplied in a nice little case that can be placed into a tray that slides out from the side of the mouse. The case has something else which you don't find in your everyday mice—mouse feet. There are 2 additional sets which you can replace by snapping at the back of the mouse.

The market price for the Sidewinder is Rs 3,050. It's not as over-the-top expensive as the Razer Lachesis or the other high-end gaming

mice, but it isn't that stacked with performance figures either. For the price of the Sidewinder, one would expect features like a tilt scroll wheel. It might not be something every gamer would spend on willingly, but surely people with an inclination towards large mice will love this.

Specifications
Sensor Resolution: 2000 dpi, USB Refresh rate: 500 Hz

Contact: Microsoft India
Phone: +91-80-66586575
E-mail: geethakb@microsoft.com
Web site: www.microsoft.com
Price: Rs 3,050

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Tagan TG1300-BZ

Even More...Power!!

Mounting power requirements for performance systems don't seem to slow down. With single graphics card consumption close to 200–300 W each, SLI and quad-SLI setups are very demanding. As its name suggests it's a 1300 W power supply.

Like with some other Tagan power supplies, the TG1300-BZ too has the round connectors with a nut screw to tighten. The sockets are lit up and the cables are of good quality—long and also well sheathed. A perfectly fitting rubber gasket acts as a buffer to absorb vibration and keep noise low. It is provided separately and fits between the power supply and the cabinet. A 135 mm fan is used for cooling the power supply. Gold plated connectors have been used for all the cables.

For the test, we plugged in 3 hard drives, an optical drive and two 9800 GTXs in SLI. The system ran flawlessly .

The package by itself gives an idea that this is a costly and premium product. The power supply comes in a fancy carry bag with an additional pouch for cables. There are anti-static gloves supplied as well. Even the crocodile



leather-styled manual is extremely detailed and explains every thing of setting up the power supply in detail. Other extras include a small screw driver.

No matter how much of a premium product the Tagan TG1300-BZ might be, it is by no means cheap especially with a price tag of Rs 16,700. The demand for this colossal amount of power is usually not required even with the most powerful of systems.

Specifications

Maximum power: 1300W, ATX standard, Weight: 3.4 kgs

Contact: NanoPoint Technology Ltd.
Phone: +91-33-22251192
E-mail: mail@tirupati.net
Web site: www.tagan.com
Price: Rs 16,700

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Brother MFC-685CW

Awesome Value For Money

Brother's MFC-685CW is an all-round multifunction device. Among its few flaws is that the USB or network cable has to be guided through a small crevice along one side of the MFD to the centre.



Like any other MFD, it performs the typical scan, print and copy functions. It also has a memory card reader which can read from a variety of memory cards, and support for USB flash drives. That's not all—it has both wireless and wired network connectivity, which means it acts as a network printer as well.

The quality of photo prints is good, but colours —red especially—turned out a little pink. In the other text and image prints, there is a little difference in the density of the colours between the normal and fine quality prints. It is close to twice as fast in the normal mode than the fine mode.

At Rs 13,630, this is an awesome bargain. There are just way too many features in this MFD to go on about. It does pretty much everything you'd possibly want an MFD to do.

Specifications

Maximum printing resolution: 6000x1200 dpi, Scanner resolution: 600x2400 dpi, Interfaces: USB, Ethernet, WiFi 802.11 b/g, 32 MB Memory

Contact: Brother International (India) Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: +91-22-40988900
E-mail: info@brother.in
Web site: www.brother.in
Price: Rs 13,630

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★